



BE READY.

Option

Running option

Running sessions of 30 to 45 minutes, on top of your program, to build your aerobic base and your ability to keep going.

Session

30 to 45 min

Pre-season

1 to 2 per week

In season

1 per week

For personal use only, do not share. This program is for people in good health: if you feel pain, have an injury or are in doubt, stop and ask a health professional for advice.

What this option is for

Running builds the "engine": a heart and muscles that recover faster between two actions. These sessions complement your main program, they do not replace it.

At the gym

The best is a **curved treadmill** (non-motorised, curved: you drive the belt yourself, with no set speed). You use the same pace guides as outside, and accelerations come naturally.

- **No curved treadmill:** motorised treadmill for easy runs and tempo (1 % incline), assault bike (air bike) or rowing machine for intervals, with the same work and recovery times.
- **Hills:** on the curved treadmill, 15 to 20 seconds of all-out pushing; otherwise, 15-second sprints on the assault bike.
- The pace zones stay the same: easy, steady, hard.

Where to fit them in your week

- **Pre-season:** 1 session per week at level 1, 2 sessions at levels 2 and 3. On a day without an A, B or C session, or on the same day at least 6 hours later.
- **In season:** 1 session per week, at least 3 days before the match. If you have already run a lot in practice or in a match, replace it with an easy 25-minute run.
- Never two hard sessions (intervals, hills) two days in a row.

Setting your pace without a watch

Zone	Guide	Used for
Easy	You can hold a conversation	Warm-up, easy runs, recovery
Steady	You can say a few words, not sentences	Tempo, long intervals
Hard	Impossible to talk	Short intervals, hills

Every session

Step	Duration
Warm-up: easy jog, then 3 progressive accelerations	10 min
Main part	15 to 25 min
Cool-down: very slow jog or walk, light stretches	5 to 10 min

Shoes: running shoes, not your indoor court shoes. On roads or trails, avoid flat-soled shoes.

The session types

Progressive run

Continuous running that starts in the easy zone and finishes, over the last 5 minutes, in the steady zone.

Key points: Start slower than you think.

Fartlek

Continuous running with free accelerations: for example 1 minute steady, 2 minutes easy, repeated.

Key points: The pace changes, but you never stop.

Tempo

One continuous block in the steady zone, at an even pace.

Key points: You must be able to hold the same pace to the end.

Long intervals

Reps of 2 to 3 minutes in the steady to hard zone, with 1 minute 30 of jogging recovery.

Key points: Same pace on every rep.

Short 30-30 intervals

30 seconds fast, 30 seconds of jogging, continuously.

Key points: Fast but not a sprint: you must be able to hold every rep.

Hills

Fast run up a hill for 15 to 20 seconds, walk back down.

Key points: Short quick steps, trunk leaning slightly forward, active arms.

Pre-season: your 8-week plan

At level 1, only do session 1 each week. At levels 2 and 3, do both.

Weeks	Session 1	Session 2 (levels 2 and 3)
1-2	Easy run 25-30 min	Progressive run 30 min
3	Fartlek 30 min (1 min steady / 2 min easy)	Easy run 35 min
4	Long intervals: 4 × 2 min	Progressive run 35 min
5	Long intervals: 5 × 2 min 30	Tempo: 2 × 8 min, 2 min of jogging in between
6	Short intervals: 2 × 8 min of 30-30	Hills: 8 × 15 s
7	Short intervals: 2 × 10 min of 30-30	Hills: 10 × 20 s
8	Easy run 25 min + 4 accelerations	Rest

The durations given are for the main part, without the warm-up or cool-down. In total, a session lasts 30 to 45 minutes.

In season: your 12-week plan

One session per week, rotating over 4 weeks. Start the cycle again in weeks 5 and 9.

Week of the cycle	Session
1	Fartlek 25 min
2	Long intervals: 4 × 2 min
3	Short intervals: 2 × 6 min of 30-30
4 (lighter)	Easy run 25 min

Pain in the shin, knee or heel that gets worse while running: stop the session. Pain that comes back on every run must be seen by a health professional.

A question about the program? Just reply to the email that sent you this document.